

Now all the woods are sleeping

Text: Paul Gerhardt, 1648

tr. and alt. Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

O WELT, ICH MUSS DICH LASSEN 776.778

Music: Heinrich Isaac, 1539

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of D major (two sharps), and 6/8 time. It consists of three staves of music. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some lines having multiple verses. The first staff has four verses, the second staff has two verses, and the third staff has two verses. The music is simple and melodic, with a mix of quarter and eighth notes.

1 Now all the woods are sleep - ing, the night and still - ness creep - ing
2 Why Sun, are you re - treat - ing, and Moon, in dance, now lead - ing
3 Now ob - li - ga - tion ceas - es, this Night the tired re - leas - es
4 My loved ones, rest se - cure - ly, from ev - 'ry per - il sure - ly

o'er ci - ty, field, and beast; but thou, my heart, a - wake be,
the anc - ient bal - lad, Night? Re - flect - ing rays, we glist - en,
and bids you sleep be - gin: My love, there comes a mor - row
pro - tect - ed be your heads; may hap - py slum - bers mend you,

with pray'r - ful thanks, at - tend thee, to dear - est Trea - sures ere thou rest.
we laugh, and talk, and list - en, re - sound - ing, gen - tle notes of light.
shall set thee free from sor - row, and all the anx - ious toil with - in.
and ev - 'ry care at - tend you, as trus - ted souls watch o'er your beds.